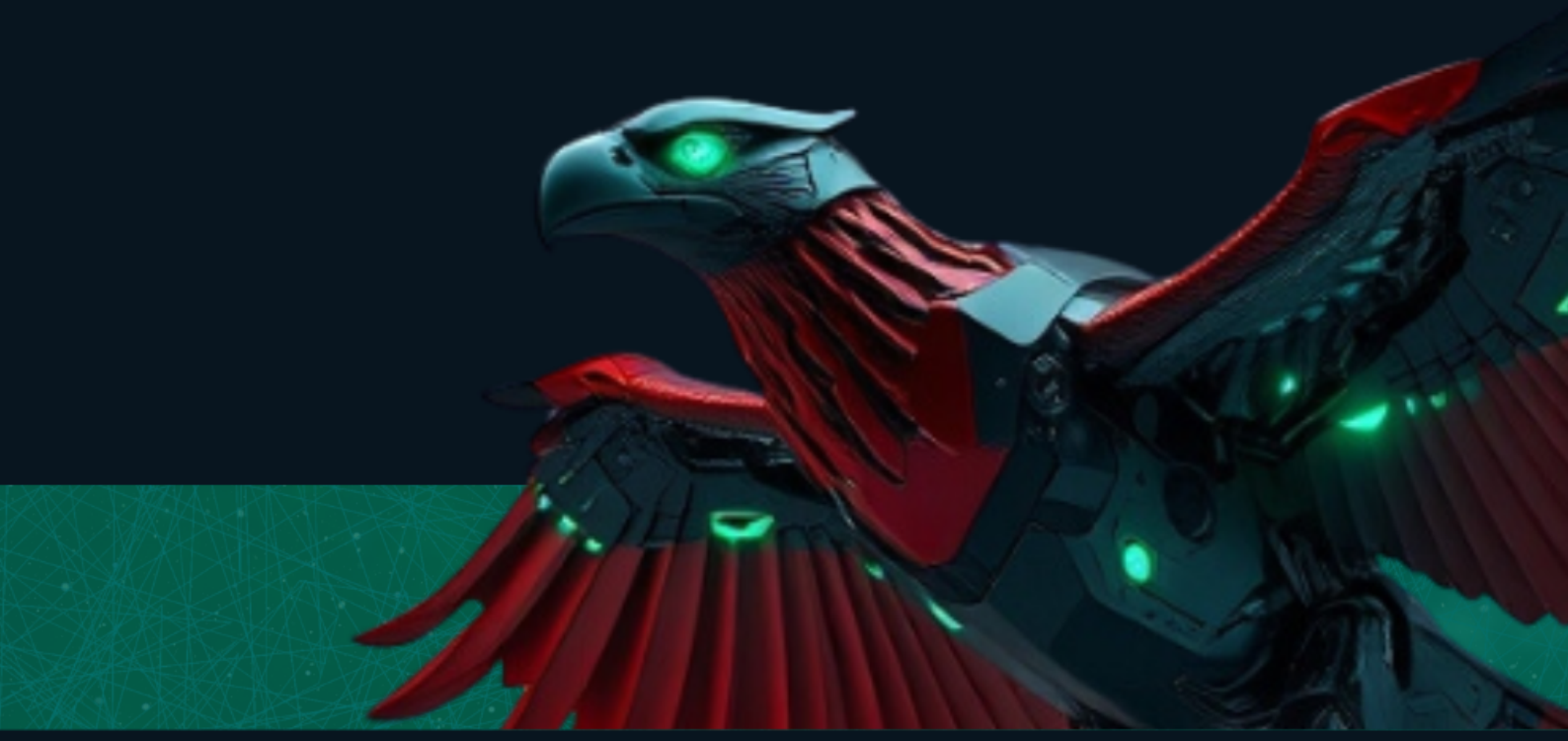
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INTEL REPORT



Report Details

Title	Threat Hunt | Primitive Bear
Sub Title	An active, state-sponsored cyber espionage threat group originating from the Russian Federation
Status	Closed
Type	Alert
Severity	—
Source	US News
Created At	Jun 09, 2026, 10:16 PM

Threat Hunt | Primitive Bear

An active, state-sponsored cyber espionage threat group originating from the Russian Federation

Type: ALERT • Source: US News • Created At: Jun 09, 2026, 10:16 PM

Analysis Summary

On June 9th at 9:05 PM, Cythority's vSOC conducted a threat hunt focused on Primitive Bear, covering activity within the past 30 days.

Primitive Bear is an active, state-sponsored cyber espionage threat group originating from the Russian Federation. Operationally active since at least late 2012, this adversary functions primarily as a targeted intelligence-gathering arm, focusing its aggressive campaigns heavily against government, military, legal, and law enforcement sectors in Ukraine and surrounding Eastern European nations. Unlike many advanced persistent threats (APTs) that prioritize stealth and long-term, quiet persistence, PRIMITIVE BEAR is distinct for its high operational velocity. They rely on rapid infrastructure churn and a massive volume of spearphishing campaigns to overwhelm defenses and exfiltrate high-value documents as quickly as possible.

The Indicators of Compromise (IoCs) associated with PRIMITIVE BEAR reflect their fast-paced, highly automated approach to network exploitation. A defining characteristic of their technical footprint is the massive deployment of domains registered through dynamic DNS services and fast-flux configurations. These domains are leveraged for command-and-control (C2) communication, allowing the group to constantly rotate their infrastructure and bypass traditional reputation-based domain blocking. Analysts tracking this adversary utilize these rapidly changing network indicator - alongside specific, recurring patterns in HTTP requests and custom SOCKS5 proxy port traffic- to identify active beaconing from infected endpoints.

On the host side, their IoCs are heavily defined by the footprint of custom scripting and modular backdoors like *Pterodo*. Security teams detect their presence through distinct registry modifications, such as altered

Outlook Visual Basic for Applications (VBA) project paths designed to hijack legitimate email clients, and unique file-naming conventions that masquerade as core Windows system utilities (e.g., variations of svchost.exe). Furthermore, because the group frequently relies on weaponized .lnk (shortcut) files, malicious HTML applications (.hta), and obfuscated VBScript delivered via compressed archives, specific file hashes and atypical executions of native command interpreters like wscript.exe serve as critical tactical indicators to hunt for and disrupt their active campaigns.

During this hunt, a total of 64,051 Indicators of Compromise (IOCs) were identified, including domains, URLs, IP addresses, email addresses, filenames, and file hash values. These indicators were aggregated from CrowdStrike, internal telemetry, and additional intelligence sources referenced in this report. All identified IOCs were enriched using OSINT and threat intelligence platforms to validate their reputation. Analysis confirmed that the indicators are associated with malicious activity.

A CQL Advanced Event Search was conducted across the environment to identify any evidence of activity related to these indicators. No matches or suspicious activity were observed, confirming no current or historical presence within the environment. As a preventative measure, the validated malicious IOCs have been added to the IOC Management Block List to mitigate potential future exposure. This proactive control strengthens the security posture and reduces the attack surface.

Based on the investigation and analysis performed, no impact to the environment has been identified and no further action is required at this time.

Targeted Industries:

Government, Legal, Academic, Law Enforcement, Military

Targeted Countries:

Latvia Moldova Poland Lithuania Ukraine

Community Identifiers:

Operation Armageddon, WINTERFLOUNDER, Shuckworm, Gamaredon, IRON TILDEN, APT-C-53, UNC530, Trident Ursa, TEMP.Armageddon, SpiceyHoney Campaign, ACTINIUM, Blue Otso, UAC-0010, Aqua Blizzard, BlueAlpha

Affected Product

- Microsoft Windows
- Microsoft Office (Word and Excel)
- Microsoft Outlook
- Microsoft Teams
- Third-Party Web and Storage Services
- USB and Removable Media Flash Drives

Impact

- Acquire Infrastructure (T1583)
- Spearphishing Attachment (T1566.001)
- Internal Spearphishing (T1534)
- Command and Scripting Interpreter (T1059)
- Scheduled Task/Job (T1053)
- Native API (T1106)
- Registry Run Keys / Startup Folder (T1547.001)
- Office Application Startup (T1137)
- Obfuscated Files or Information (T1027)
- Masquerading (T1036.005)
- File and Directory Discovery (T1083)
- Peripheral Device Discovery (T1120)
- Screen Capture (T1113)
-

Web Service (T1102)

- Non-Application Layer Protocol (T1095)
- Automated Exfiltration (T1020)

Indicators of Compromise (IOCs)

SHA256 Hashes

- 19888c043afde1f63f25a807192170bc65377e6c89f693ad7af70c0a03a349ed
- 60539634489764d9e590433ef632727aa465075befcb4f2d4f60405c0f8e600c
- Be7d70fb705c74f2de86db2b34f3e7587e5b3ded2d02eaad48fcfee426379372
- 782a8cc34746ca1ffc7cd83a9cc4cd64c60de2e69622a06d2a01792df2e2573c
- 7c2c376300c1fc562521196458c2594edac152f1ad944c517927b5a12193980c
- 3d80541e59b4bedac6bd275514c0941b1478d62d6ef8b8560720d05a83c0a910

IP

- 212[.]193[.]20[.]110
- 159[.]203[.]17[.]42
- 64[.]227[.]150[.]85
- 139[.]59[.]68[.]61
- 87[.]120[.]219[.]114
- 134[.]122[.]106[.]156

DOMAIN
military-ukraine[.]online
adelen[.]ru
akashito[.]ru
akinot[.]ru
lopezx[.]ru
palutas[.]ru

Remediation

- Disable Remote Template Injection
- Restrict Inbound Script Extensions
- Harden Spam Filtering
- Restrict Script Interpreters
- Enforce PowerShell Constrained Language Mode
- Block Office Macro Access to VBOM
- Monitor Registry Run Key Changes
- Audit and Limit Scheduled Tasks
- Implement Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA)

- Enforce USB Read/Write Restrictions
- Identify Fast-Flux and Dynamic DNS Access
- Inspect Non-Standard Port Traffic